**2. Pick out the words from the passage which mean the same as the following.**

a) succeeded (para 4)

b) very hot (para 6)

c) against the flow (para 8)

d) the inter connectedness of organisms (para 9)

e) providing care (para 9)

**3. Find words from the passage which mean the opposite of the following.**

a) saved (para 1)

b) small scale (para 2)

c) far away (para 2)

d) foreign (para 3)

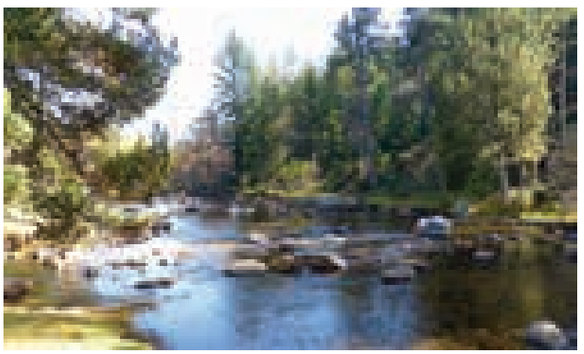
e) finally (para 6)

**c. Read the following poem carefully.**

**A River**

*- By A.K. Ramananujan*

In Madurai,
city of temples and poets,
who sang of cities and temples,
every summer
a river dries to a trickle
in the sand,
baring the sand ribs,
straw and women's hair
clogging the watergates
at the rusty bars
under the bridges with patches
of repair all over them
the wet stones glistening like sleepy
crocodiles, the dry ones
shaven water-buffaloes lounging in the sun
The poets only sang of the floods.
He was there for a day
when they had the floods.
People everywhere talked
of the inches rising,



of the precise number of cobbled steps
run over by the water, rising
on the bathing places,
and the way it carried off three village houses,
one pregnant woman
and a couple of cows
named Gopi and Brinda as usual.

The new poets still quoted
the old poets, but no one spoke
in verse
of the pregnant woman



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